

Email to Meghan — ready to copy/paste

To: Meghan **From:** Sheri (sheri@zadagroup.ca or your campaign address) **Subject:** Plan & next steps — website, FB response, volunteers

Hi Meghan,

I want to take a step back and walk you through where things stand and what I think the order of operations should be over the next couple of weeks. I know it's been a lot — this email is meant to make it feel less so.

The good news first. The website was only briefly live, and it was never advertised — no Facebook share, no press, no email blast. The only people who saw it were people deliberately looking for it. The Rocky Point Park error circulating in the FB community groups is contained and recoverable. We're in good shape to fix this cleanly and come back stronger.

Here's what I think the order should be:

1. Today — short FB acknowledgment from you.

Before any other moves, I'd suggest you drop a short comment in the FB threads where the screenshots are circulating. Something like:

"Thanks for catching these! Our site went live before our final review — we're fixing the errors today and will have the corrected version up shortly. Really appreciate the eagle eyes from the community."

That neutralizes the screenshots immediately and shows you're on top of it. People forgive mistakes acknowledged early — the only thing they don't forgive is silence.

2. This week into next — website rebuilt, fact-checked, and back up.

I've already gone through every page line by line, fact-checked against public sources, and applied every confirmed correction I could find — the Rocky Point Park language, the Coronation Park / Portwood mix-up (the website was conflating two different developments), the BC Housing dollar figures, the "30 years on council" framing, several typos, and an internal inconsistency on ground-breaking dates.

What's left is a list of items I need **YOU** to verify before we relaunch — specific dollar figures, dates, awards wording, claims like "first female mayor in 109 years," and a few questions about endorsements I want to be careful with.

I've made your review as easy as possible. Rather than send you a static document to mark up, I'm going to share the website-content-review as a **Google Doc** with you in **"Suggesting" mode**. That means: open the link on your phone, tap any text you want changed, type the change — it auto-shows up in a different colour and I see it in real time. No emailing anything back, no pen on paper, no "list of changes" to write up. Just tap and type as you read. The link is coming in a separate message so I can grant you edit access cleanly.

A few things I want to flag for that review:

- I've already gone page by page and applied every confirmed correction I could verify (the Rocky Point Park language, the Coronation/Portwood mix-up, the BC Housing dollar figures, the "30 years on council" framing, several typos, internal inconsistencies on dates).
- I've also removed the April 16 kickoff-event references from the site, since that's behind us. We can replace that announcement bar with the official campaign launch date once you're ready to lock that in.
- What's left is a list of items I need YOU to verify — specific dollar figures, dates, awards wording, and a few judgment calls. Those are flagged with a ► symbol throughout the doc, so you'll see exactly what to look at as you scroll.

3. After the website is solid — official announcement post (using the Butters Studio video).

I have caption drafts ready and a posting strategy queued. The reason I want to wait on this: the moment you formally announce, traffic spikes, and you want the website rock-solid before that happens. Better one good week of relaunch + announcement than a rushed announcement on a shaky site.

On the back-end of the website.

When I'm back from Disneyland (week of May 5), I'd like to sit down with you in person, walk you through where the website lives and how to access it, and give you logins. That way if anything ever comes up where you want to check, change, or take down something on the site, you have direct control. I should have built that hand-off in from day one — that's on me.

Volunteer system + thank-you email to attendees.

I have an email template ready to send to all the fundraiser attendees and to the people who signed up through the volunteer form (we have four so far — Lucy, Leah, Aaron, and Aidan). The full draft is in the package I'm sending you so you can approve the wording before it goes out.

Quick decision I need from you: **which email address should this come from?**

- **Option A — meghan@lahti2026.com.** Most personal, highest open rates. Downside: replies come to you and add inbox volume. *If you go this route, would you be comfortable sharing the password with me so I can manage replies on your behalf? That keeps it personal-feeling but takes the burden off you.*
- **Option B — info@lahti2026.com.** Campaign-branded, fully managed by me, completely off your plate. Slightly less personal but very clean.
- **Option C — from me directly (sheri@...).** Easiest and most casual. Works for the volunteer pipeline; less ideal for the fundraiser thank-you.

My recommendation: **Option A if you're comfortable sharing access, otherwise Option B.** Let me know and I'll send the emails out before I leave Sunday.

One thing I want to flag personally. Among the people who gave me their cards at the fundraiser was **Janet Andrews, Secretary-Treasurer of the New Westminster & District Labour Council.** I held off reaching out until we talked — a short follow-up from us could open a real conversation about labour endorsements. I'd love your input on tone and timing before I email her.

Looking ahead — the next two weeks.

Once the website is back up, here's what I think we should align on next so we don't lose momentum.

1. The budget conversation. You mentioned wanting to talk budget — yes, let's. I know Anthony is already handling expenses, the campaign account is set up, and Stripe is collecting donations, so we're well past the "do we have an account?" phase. To put a real plan together, the four things I still need are:

- **Current total raised** (the Stripe + bank balance number as of today)
- **Outstanding pledges** — anyone who committed at the fundraiser but hasn't sent payment yet
- **Total raise target by election day** — your gut number is fine, we'll refine together
- **A list of expenses Anthony has already paid** — even a quick text from him with categories and amounts is enough; I just need to plug them into the tracker so we have a single source of truth

Two requests that would save us hours over the campaign:

- **Could I get read access to Stripe?** Just view-only, so the budget tracker stays current automatically and I can flag any donor approaching the BC \$1,429.70 individual cap without having to ask Anthony every time.
- **Would Anthony mind a 15-minute walkthrough with me** when I'm back from Disneyland — just so we have a clean handoff on what categories he's tracking and how he wants invoices submitted?

Once I have those numbers, I can give you a clean breakdown by category — signs, mailers, digital, print, events, photography, contingency — with exactly how many homes/voters each dollar reaches.

2. The budget tracker tool. I'm building us a simple spreadsheet that lives in one place: total funds at the top, vendor rates pre-loaded (per sign, per mailer, per door, etc.), and a running tally of committed vs. spent vs. remaining. Every time we add a new expense — say "5,000 mailers to Coronation Park at \$0.42 per piece" — it updates automatically and shows what's left. That gives both of us instant visibility on what's affordable as decisions come up. I'll have v1 ready before I leave Sunday so you can play with it.

3. First Think Tank — let's pick a date. Aidan signed up specifically for think tanks, and Leah is keen to be involved beyond door-knocking. I'd like to lock in our **first session for Tuesday, May 12 (7-9pm)** — first week I'm back from Disney. Format: 6-10 invitees, focused agenda on Housing (since it's the loudest issue), light refreshments, structured discussion → key takeaways → action items.

Two questions for you: - Is May 12 a yes from you? - Could we host at your place, or would you prefer I book a community-centre room?

If we lock the date now, I can put it in the volunteer outreach emails this week so people have something concrete to commit to.

4. Volunteer system. Once think-tank #1 is on the calendar and the website is live, I'll start moving everyone in our volunteer pipeline through a simple onboarding flow: welcome email → ask about interest area → first action (door-knock training, sign hosting, think-tank invite, etc.). Leah has offered to help me run this, which will save us a lot of time. I'll get her properly set up the week I'm back.

Last thing — please don't worry. Nothing here is a fire. The site is offline so no errors are spreading. The FB chatter dies down quickly once you post the acknowledgment. The volunteer signups are happy to wait a few more days. We're in a contained situation with a clear path through it.

I leave for Disneyland Sunday morning and I'm back the week of May 5. If you can review the content doc and give me direction on the email options before then, I can have everything queued up and ready to ship the moment we're aligned.

Thank you for trusting me with this. We're going to come out of this stronger than if the site had launched perfectly.

Talk soon,

Sheri

Coming in follow-up messages: - A **Google Doc link** to the *Website Content for Your Review* — open on your phone, switch to Suggesting mode, edit as you scroll. Real-time, no email-back-and-forth. - A **drafts PDF** — FB response, fundraiser thank-you email, volunteer replies, business-card follow-ups, and the announcement post drafts (all for your read-and-approve). - A **Campaign Budget Tracker** Excel spreadsheet — pre-loaded with vendor estimates, BC compliance flags, scenario calculator. You'll see Funds Raised, Committed, and Remaining at a glance.

Notes for Sheri before sending

Send order:

1. **Send THIS email first.** Plain text, just the body above.
2. **Right after**, in a follow-up email or text, send the Google Doc link (see step-by-step below) and attach the budget tracker Excel file + drafts PDF.

How to share the website-content-review as a Google Doc (5 minutes):

1. Open Google Drive (drive.google.com) on your computer.
2. Click "+ New" → "File upload" → choose 04_WEBSITE_CONTENT_FOR_REVIEW.docx from your Downloads.

3. Once uploaded, right-click the file → “Open with” → “Google Docs.” This converts the .docx into a native Google Doc.
4. In the open Google Doc, click “Share” (top-right).
5. Add Meghan’s email address.
6. Set permission to **“Editor”** (which lets her use Suggesting mode).
7. **Important:** click the gear icon ⚙ in the share dialog and *uncheck* “Editors can change permissions and share.” This locks down the doc.
8. In the Google Doc, click the pencil icon (top-right of the document, says “Editing”) and change it from “Editing” to **“Suggesting”** as the default mode for the doc, OR include this in your note to Meghan.
9. Copy the share link, send it to Meghan.

Tell her in the message: *“Open this on your phone (Google Docs app or Safari). Switch to Suggesting mode (top-right of the screen) so your edits show in a different colour. Then just tap any text and type. I’ll see your changes as you make them.”*

Other notes:

- Adjust the From email address based on what you’re using.
- If she’s a phone-call type rather than a long-email type, swap the email body for: *“Hi Meghan — I’ve put together a calm, clear plan and a content-review doc you can mark up on your phone. Sharing the Google Doc + budget tracker shortly. Happy to walk you through it on a 15-min call any time. Short version: 1) FB response today, 2) Website fixes, 3) Announcement after Disney.”* Then send the docs in follow-ups.
- Don’t apologize. You haven’t done anything wrong. The “this is on me” line about back-end access is enough humility — anything more starts to undercut your authority as her campaign manager.